

Show system executables with errors/failures from today's journal

Author: marcos

Date: 2026-04-22

Lists system executables that have generated failure, error, or fatal messages in today's journal logs, sorted by frequency.

Language

bash

Category

system-monitoring

Command

```
echo "=== Errors/Failures in Today's Journal ===";
journalctl --no-pager --since today --grep 'fail|error|
fatal' --output json | jq -r '._EXE' | sort | uniq -c |
sort -nr | awk '{printf "%4d  %s\n", $1, $2}'
```

Explanation

The command retrieves all journal entries from today (since midnight), filters for messages containing the keywords 'fail', 'error', or 'fatal' (case-insensitive regex), outputs the results in JSON format for parsing, extracts the executable name (_EXE field) from each log entry, counts occurrences of each executable, sorts them numerically in descending order (most frequent first), and formats the output with a header and aligned columns for readability.

Tags

journalctl, systemd, logs, monitoring, troubleshooting, errors, failure, system-administration, diagnostics, debugging, logging, bash, jq, text-processing, process-management

Dependencies

systemd, jq

Arguments

None

Examples

1. `journalctl-errors-today` - Show errors/failures from today's journal
2. `journalctl --no-pager --since yesterday --grep 'fail|error|fatal' --output json | jq -r '._EXE' | sort | uniq -c | sort -nr` - Show errors/failures from yesterday's journal (raw output)

Output

```
=== Errors/Failures in Today's Journal ===
 5  /usr/bin/systemd
 3  /usr/bin/foo-daemon
 1  /usr/lib/bar-service
```

Notes

- Requires `journalctl` (`systemd`) and `jq` to be installed
- Only shows entries from the current day (midnight to now)
- Requires appropriate permissions to read journal logs
- The regex pattern `'fail—error—fatal'` matches any of these words in log messages
- Output is sorted by count (highest first) for easy identification of frequent issues

Warnings

None

See Also

- `dmesg-errors-pretty`
- `user-activity-and-quota-report`

Status

reviewed

Safety

safe

Shell

bash

Platforms

linux, gnu-linux

Created At

2026-04-22

Updated At

2026-04-22